3.3 The One-Page EPK That Commands Attention

Elite private strategy - not for redistribution

WAR-ROOM NOTES - 3.3 The One-Page EPK

THE EPK IS A DECISION INTERFACE, NOT ART

Most EPKs are a museum: beautiful, slow, and irrelevant to the person in a hurry. A decision interface is the opposite - it minimizes the time to a confident "yes" or a clean "no." Every element that doesn't answer a PD question is a tax on that decision. Design rule: if a PD can't answer all five questions in 60 seconds, the page is a wall, not a door.

THE THREE-RECEIPT CURATION RULE

The Proof Stack may hold 90 items. The EPK carries three - and only three - because three is the number a busy professional actually reads. Choose by market relevance, not by impressiveness: a Portland PD wants Portland receipts; an Austin PD wants Austin receipts. Variant EPKs per region are the mark of an operator. One master deck, three regional editions, refreshed quarterly.

THE GENRE LINE IS A FILTER, NOT A CAPTION

Amateur EPKs say "genre-fluid," "unclassifiable," or list eight genres. Operators say "genre: dark indie pop" - a sentence that lets the PD sort instantly and gives them the words to defend the add to their team. A PD who can say "it's an indie pop track with a local story" can sell you internally. A PD who can't describe your genre can't sell you at all. Clarity is an add-on: the genre line is a decision-support tool.

THE IMAGE HIERARCHY: PROOF, NOT PRETTY

Your photo should communicate stage presence (live shot, legit lights, crowd) over studio aesthetics (beauty shot with a mic). A live photo with an actual audience is a receipt; a studio pose is a wish. Use the live photo. Logos only if verifiable - an unverifiable press logo costs more credibility than it earns. Numbers with sources always beat adjectives with none.

THE LINK-DISCIPLINE: NEVER ATTACH THE EPK

Attachments get quarantined, get deleted, and die in phone apps. The EPK URL is a proof-of-professionalism move: it signals that you understand how decision-makers consume information - quickly, on mobile, with zero friction. Always send: (1) one radio edit, (2) one 90-second audio, (3) the EPK link. Nothing else. That's the payload that gets replies.